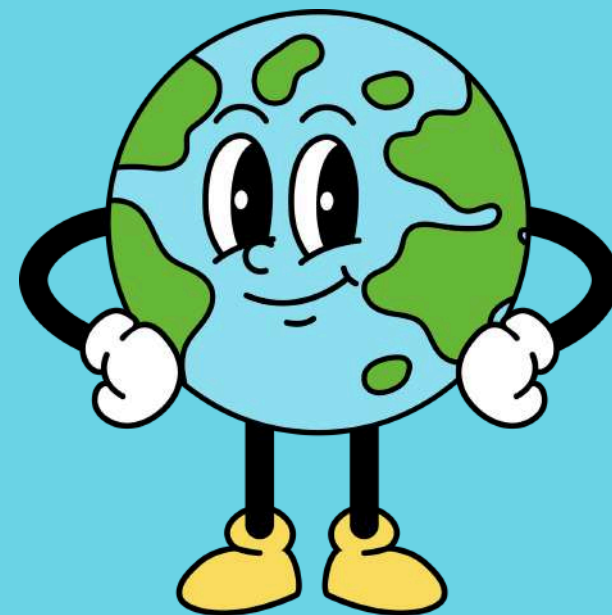


UNESCO Global Youth Hackathon 2026

Digital Content Creators &
Media Information Literacy



Elizabeth Sherr | Ocean Science Communicator | @lizlivingblue

marine scientist > communications > content creator
“ocean digital storyteller” or “multimedia journalism”

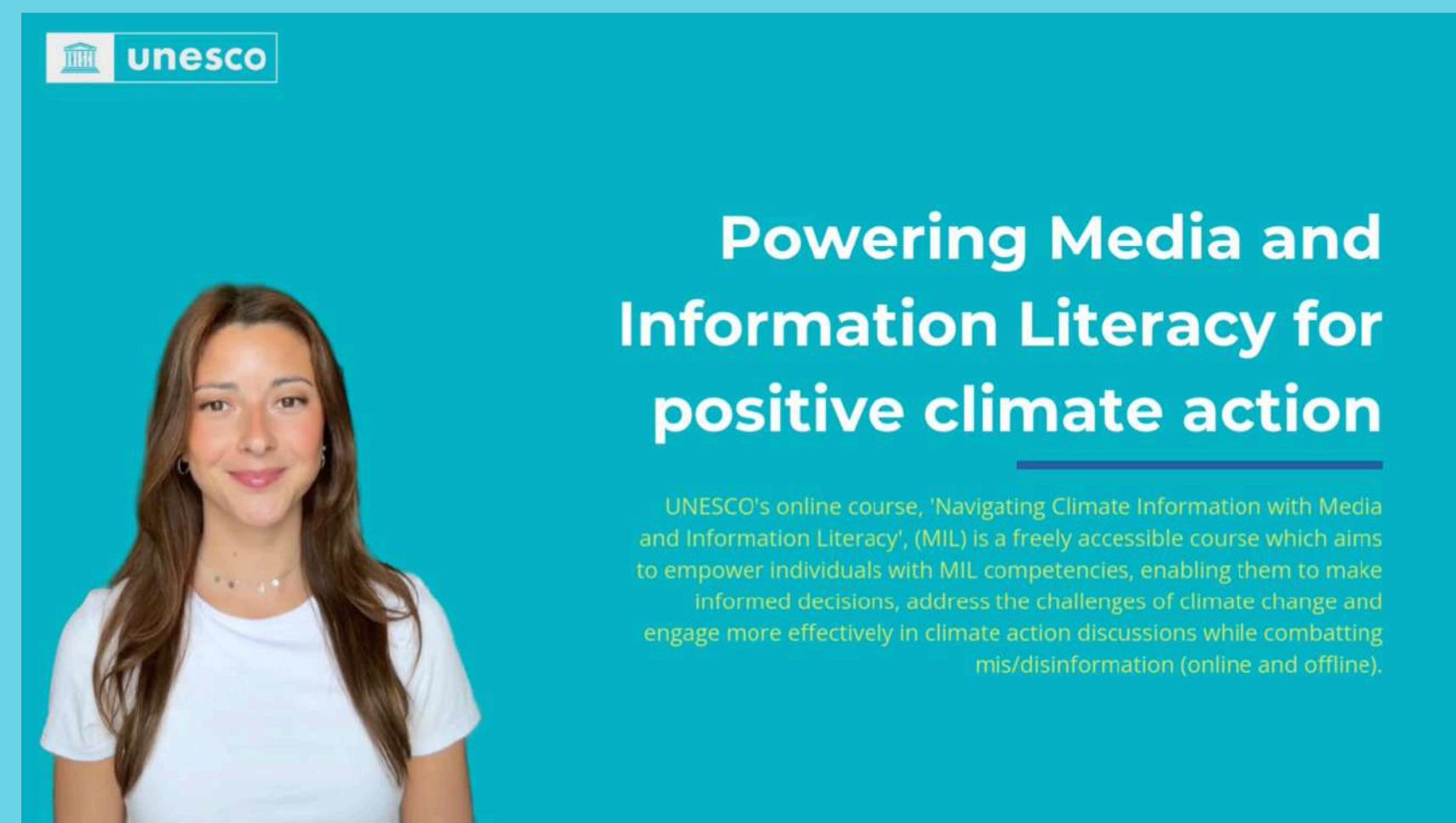
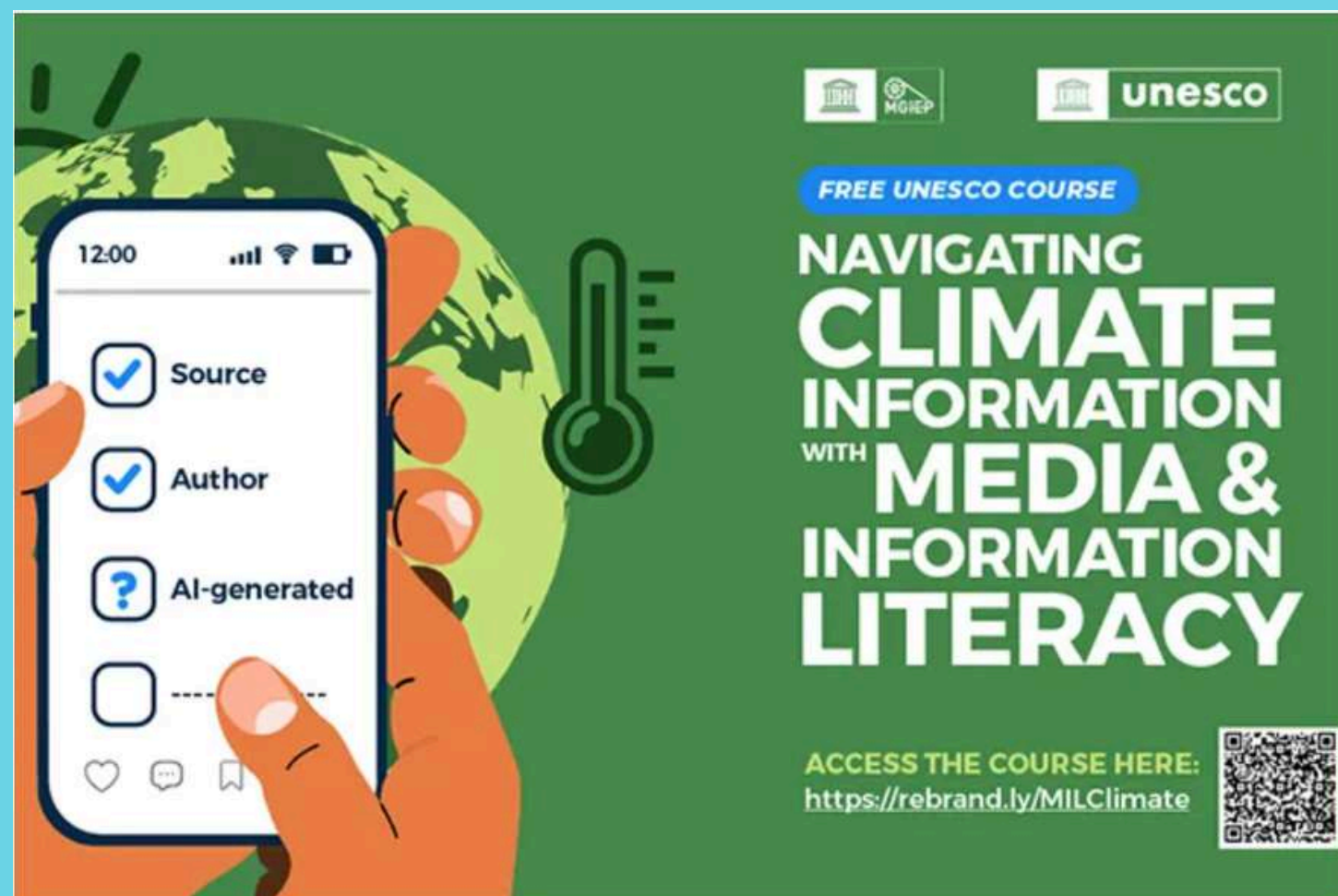


Navigating Climate Information with MIL

Available in English, French and Spanish! Take the course [here](#)

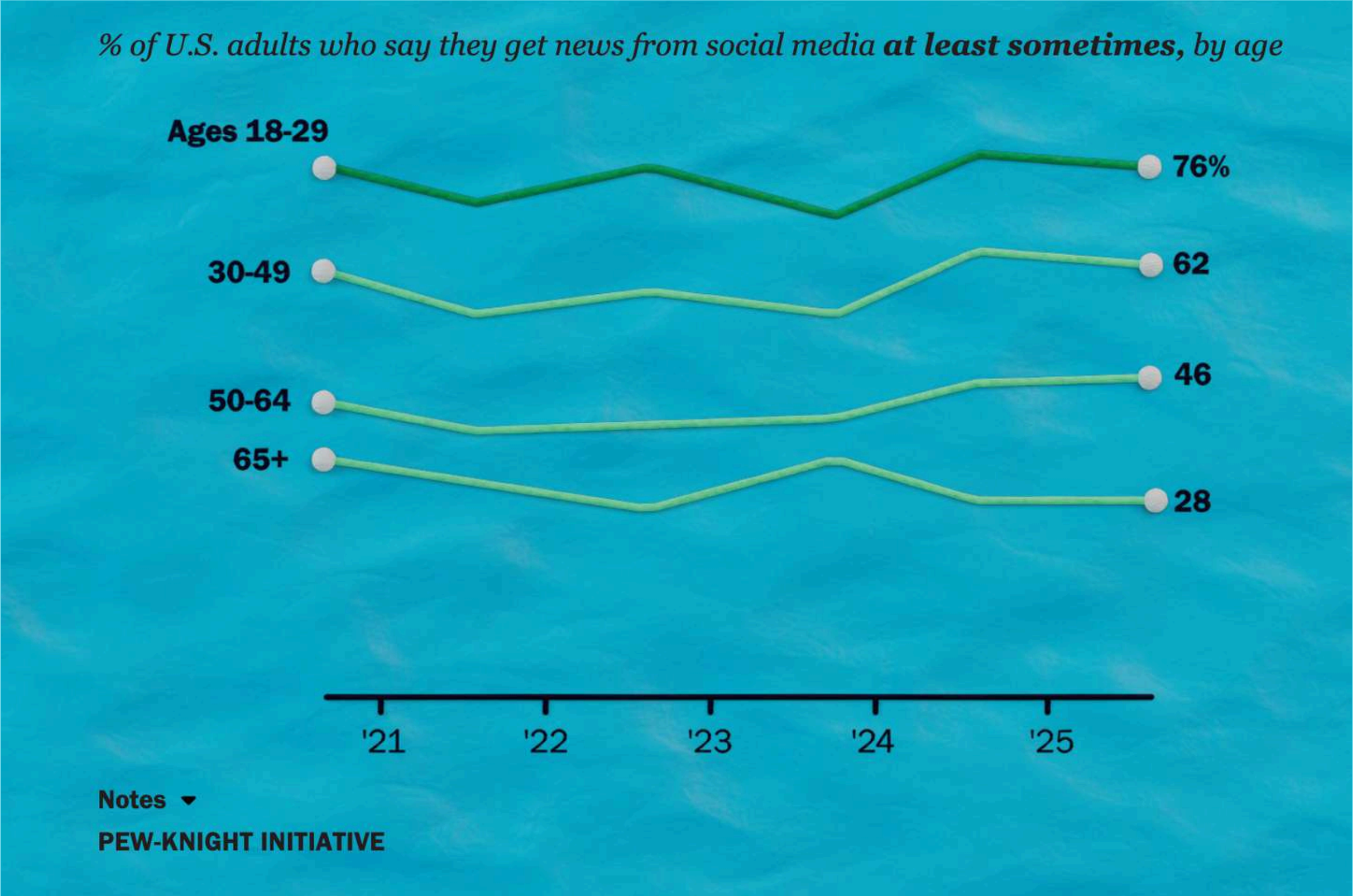


UNESCO Launches Free Online Course to Tackle Climate Disinformation through Media and Information Literacy



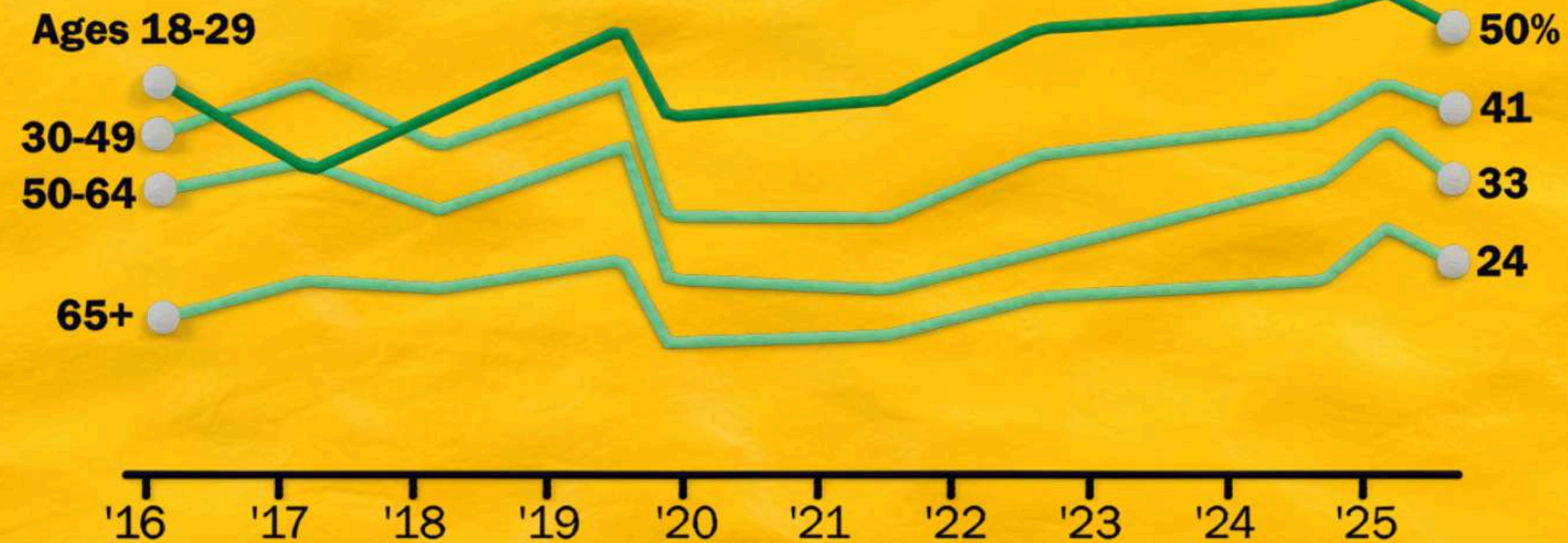
Use the raise hand emoji if you use social media to learn about the news





Source: *Pew Research Center, 2025*

*% of U.S. adults who say they have **a lot of/some trust** in the information that comes from social media sites, by age*



Notes ▼

PEW-KNIGHT INITIATIVE

Source: Pew Research Center, 2025

The Trust Problem

How do we know what's real or AI?

How do we stop spreading misinformation?

How do we build trust?



Study: 667 creators were asked about their biggest challenges. 11 themes were found.

Which of these 4 were ranked #1?

- A. Burnout
- B. Misinformation and Trust
- C. AI
- D. Monetization

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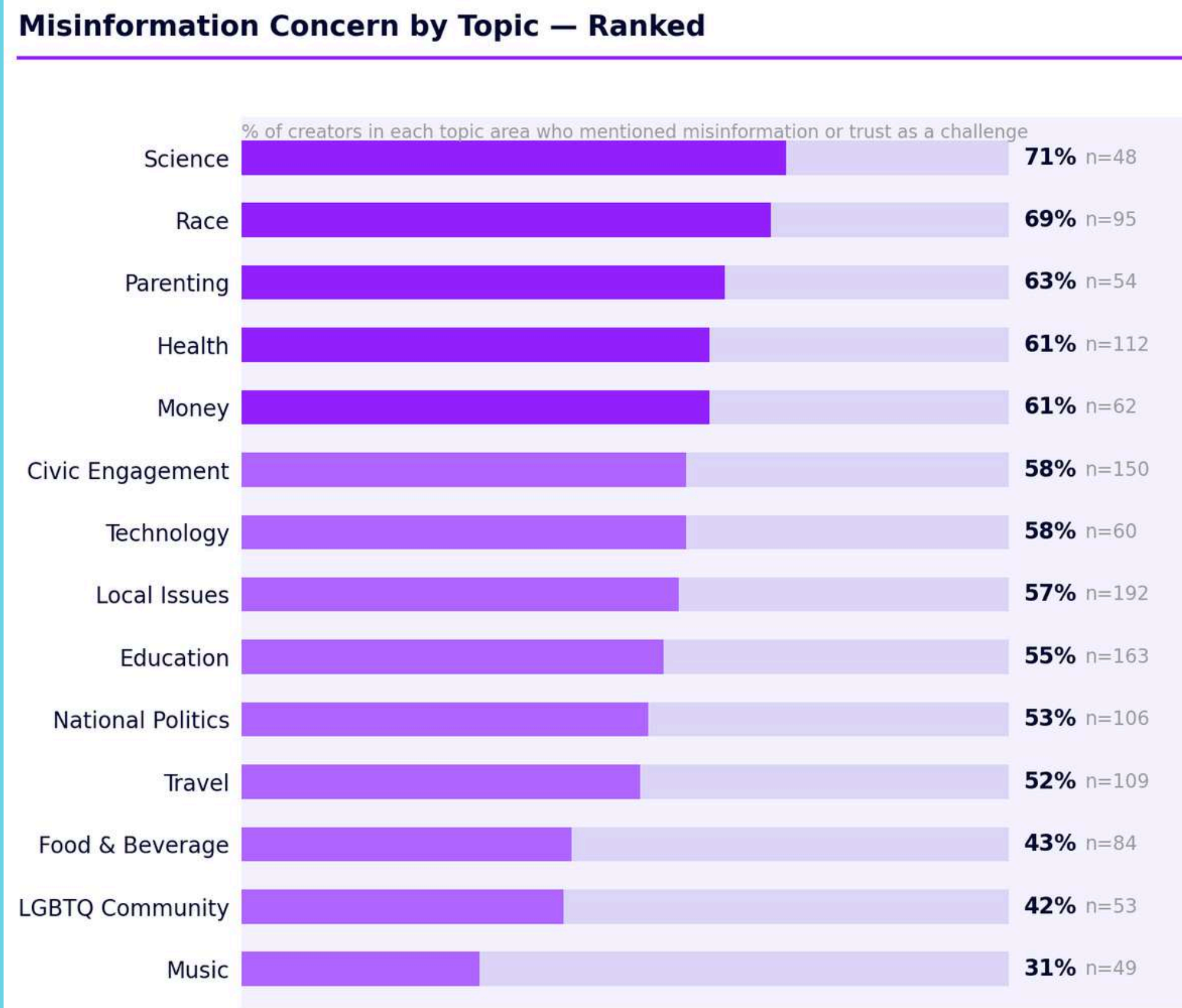
A. Burnout

B. Misinformation and Trust 57%

C. AI

D. Monetization

- Top 4:**
1. Science
 2. Race
 3. Parenting
 4. Health



Source: News Creator Corps

Real or Fake?



#1: Barnacles on a Whale

CLAIM:

A diver carefully removes barnacles from a humpback whale's skin. This is a good thing and we should do it to help whales.



#1: Barnacles on a Whale

CLAIM:

A diver carefully removes barnacles from a humpback whale's skin. This is a good thing and we should do it to help whales.



#2: The Spain & Portugal Blackout

CLAIM:

On April 28, 2025, Spain experienced 10+ hours without electricity due to European sanctions against Russia.



#2: The Spain & Portugal Blackout

BBC: “caused by rare atmospheric phenomenon”



“destruction of nuclear energy” →
2020, coal thermal power plant

Examples of dis/misinformation:

1. Using false science
2. Cherry-picking data

....others include:

- Spreading conspiracy theories
- Attacking climate solutions

Rapid Fire Video Quiz — Real or Fake?

**Okay so, how can we build
trust as creators?**

Tips to build confidece and trust:

1. Pause before you share

Tips to build confidece and trust:

1. Pause before you share
2. Trace it back to its origin.

Tips to build confidece and trust:

1. Pause before you share
2. Trace it back to its origin
3. Look for the visual tells in images and video

Tips to build confidece and trust:

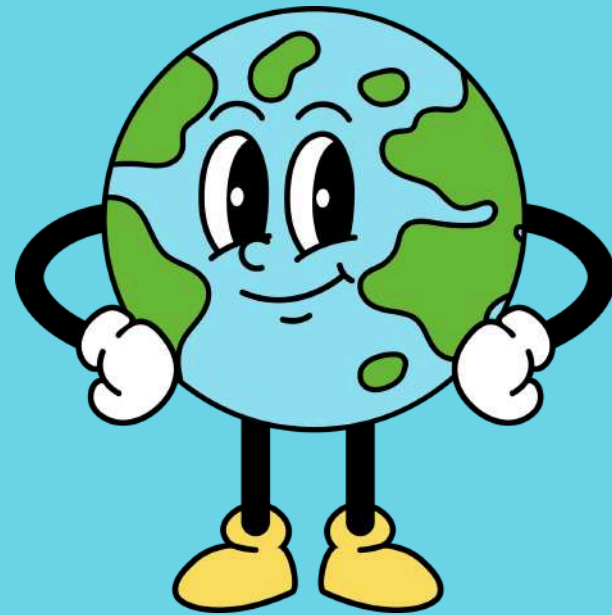
1. Pause before you share
2. Trace it back to its origin
3. Look for the visual tells in images and video
4. Use reverse image search

Tips to build confidece and trust:

1. Pause before you share
2. Trace it back to its origin
3. Look for the visual tells in images and video
4. Use reverse image search
5. Go to the primary source for science claims
6. Be transparent about what you don't know.

Helpful Resources:

- **NOAA (noaa.gov)** — Ocean and atmosphere science, authoritative global source
- **iNaturalist (inaturalist.org)** — Wildlife identification, global community science
- **AFP Fact Check (factcheck.afp.com)** — Multilingual, strong on science and environment
- **EDMO (edmo.eu)** — European fact-checking network covering disinformation across 28+ countries, strong on climate and AI
- **Climate Feedback (climatefeedback.org)** — Science-based fact-checking for climate claims
- **Reverse image search** — Google Images, TinEye, Yandex Images
- **UNESCO Climate Disinformation course** — I'll drop the link, free, now available in English, French, and Spanish



Science-backed storytelling is one of the most powerful tools we have.

Now it's your turn.